

SPECIAL

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Rayfelman



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1. Letter From the Under-Secretary General of DISEC

Dear Delegates,

It is a great pleasure to welcome you all to the DISEC Committee of RAYFELMUN'26 as the Under Secretary General of this committee. I'm honored to meet delegates who are .willing to engage in meaningful debate on some of the world's most pressing challenges

The agenda of the Disarmament and International Security Committee, 'Advancing on Safety and Providence of Disarmament and Neutralization of North Pole' focuses on the growing political, economic, environmental, and military importance of the Arctic Ocean and Greenland. As climate change accelerates the melting of Arctic ice, new trade routes, natural resources, and strategic opportunities have increased global interest in the region. However, this .situation has also created rising tensions between major powers

This committee requires delegates to think critically, negotiate diplomatically, and develop realistic solutions that balance national interests, international security, environmental .sustainability, and global cooperation

.Delegates are expected to search for realistic, balanced and long term solutions

Sincerely hope this conference will provide you with an enriching and unforgettable experience where you can strengthen your negotiation, and leadership skills while forming valuable .connections with other participants

I look forward to hear your ideas, solutions, and contributions throughout the conference. If you .have any questions feel free to contact me via my email adress below

,Best Regards

İlke Ersoyoğlu

Under Secretary General

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2. Letter From the Chairboard

Most esteemed participants,

It is a great pleasure to welcome you all to the second conference of RAYFELMUN and to our committee, DISEC. We, Ferit Umut Tuna and Batu Sönmez, are delighted to be serving as the Chairboard in this committee.

As the DISEC Committee, we will be addressing the definition and impacts of key global security challenges, including the lasting consequences of colonization, poverty, illiteracy, and prolonged conflict.

This committee aims to promote international peace and security through disarmament, conflict prevention, and strengthened cooperation among member states. Ultimately, it seeks to contribute to a more stable, secure, and prosperous global order.

You can find detailed information that you will need in this guide in order to get ready to the conference, however, if you have any further questions, we are available for help at anytime you desire, via batusonmezedirne@gmail.com and feritumuttuna@gmail.com.

We trust the distinguished delegates of our committee about their preparation and their ability to deal with the agenda. We are looking forward to meeting you all and having a wonderful experience.

Welcoming you once more to DISEC,

Ferit Umut Tuna - ACAS

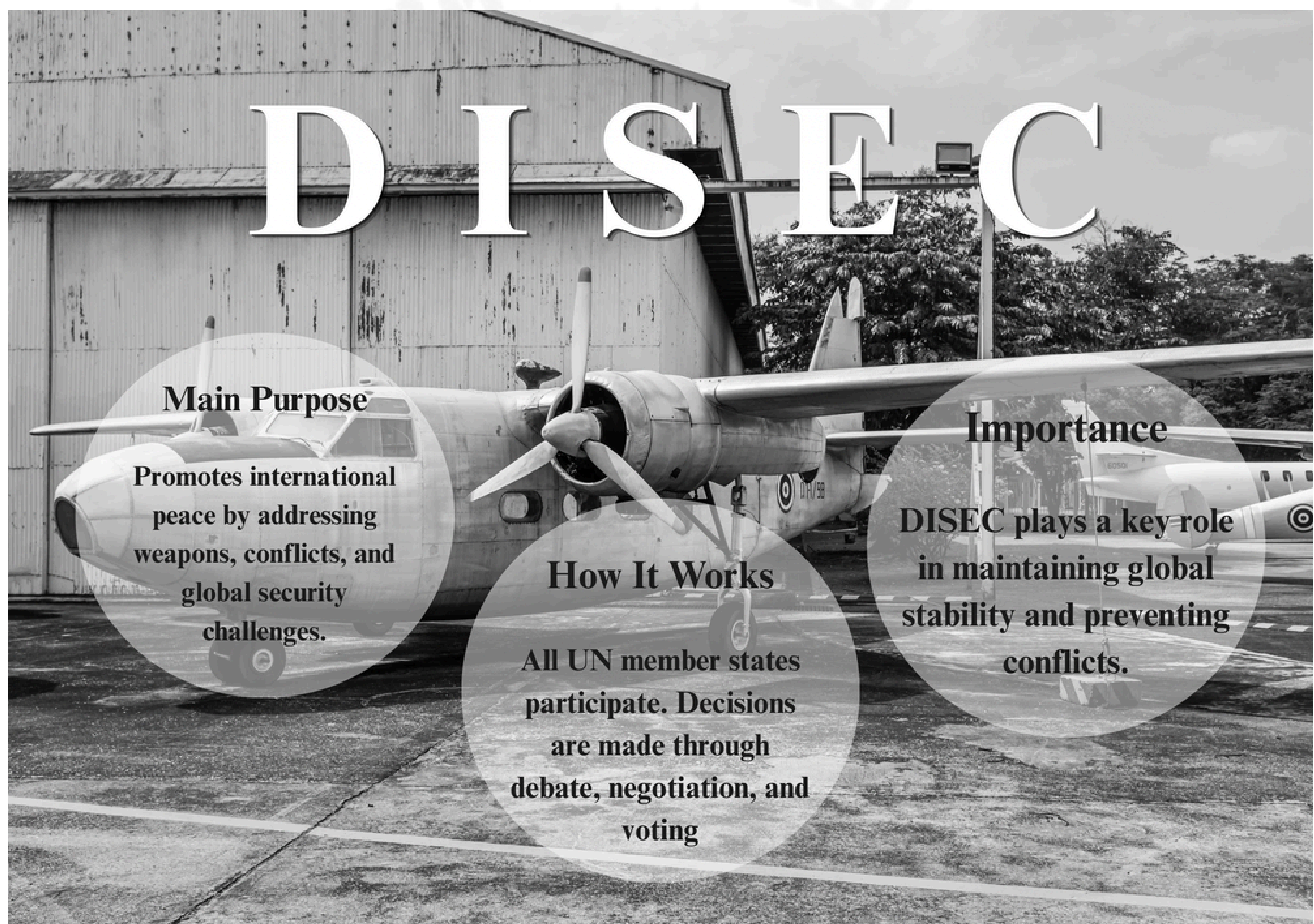
Batu Sönmez - Chair

Chairboard of DISEC

3. Introduction to the Committee: What is DISEC?

The Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) is the First Committee of the United Nations General Assembly. It addresses disarmament, global challenges, and threats to international peace and security, and seeks solutions to issues within the international security framework.

The committee considers all disarmament and international security matters within the scope of the United Nations Charter, including the principles of international cooperation for the maintenance of peace and security, the regulation and reduction of armaments, and measures aimed at promoting stability through multilateral cooperation.



4. Introduction to the Agenda Item

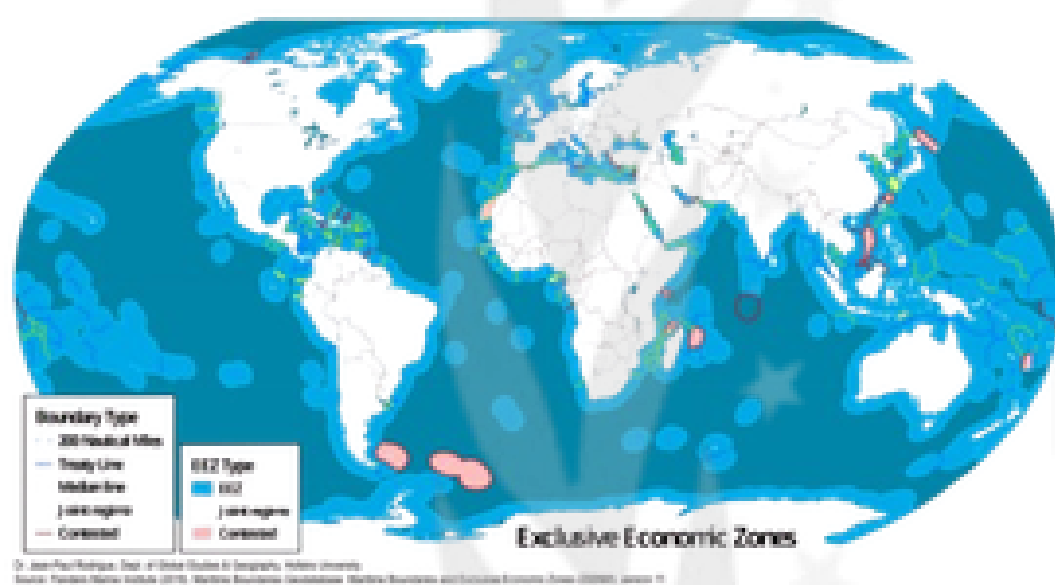
a. Key Terms

Arctic Region: Refers to the northern polar region of the world. Due to energy sources, new routes and strategic location, the competition between countries has increased.



Continental Shelf: The extension of a state's land under the sea. According to international law (UNCLOS), coastal nations have the special right to explore and take natural resources (like oil or gas) from the seabed of their continental shelf.

Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ): The ocean area up to 200 miles from a country's shore where that country alone can fish and drill for resources like oil and gas.



Freedom of Navigation: A principle that allows ships of all countries to travel freely inside international waters without interference.

Militarization of the Arctic: The increase of military forces, infrastructure and strategic operations in the Arctic region.

Northern Sea Route: A major sea route that goes through Russia's Arctic Coast. Because it shortens the distance between Europe and Asia, it is economically important.



Greenland's Strategic Importance: Greenland holds a geopolitical importance due to its location, natural resources and its strategic role in global military and surveillance systems.

NW Pass: Northwest Passage is a critical trade route to use an alternative sea route to Northern Sea Route. It



GIUK: Geographical zone between 3 countries.(Greenland,Iceland and United Kingdom)



Rare Earth Elements:

Greenland maintains one of the widest REE reserves in the world (Nearly 36-38 million tonnes). REE's mostly used in high technology based industries such as AI, power plants (Nuclear solar plant, HEPP etc.) It can reduce foreign dependency and expensiveness on REE's.

b. Strategic Importance of Greenland

Greenland has a serious strategic importance because of its location, which makes it a key point in Arctic geopolitics. The area plays an important role at monitoring sea and air routes including commercial and military traffic and makes it valuable especially for NATO. Also, Greenland is significantly rich in natural resources like oil, natural gas and rare elements. As ice melts due to climate change, it forms new sea routes and makes access to resources easier which increases the value of the area. Because of these, major powerful countries such as Russia and the USA considered Greenland as a critical area from every angle.

c. Geographic Importance

Greenland holds a strategic region in the Arctic due to its location between North America and Europe. It is located in GIUK (strategic maritime chokepoint in the North Atlantic) Gap which is a critical checkpoint for naval movements.

d. Economic Importance

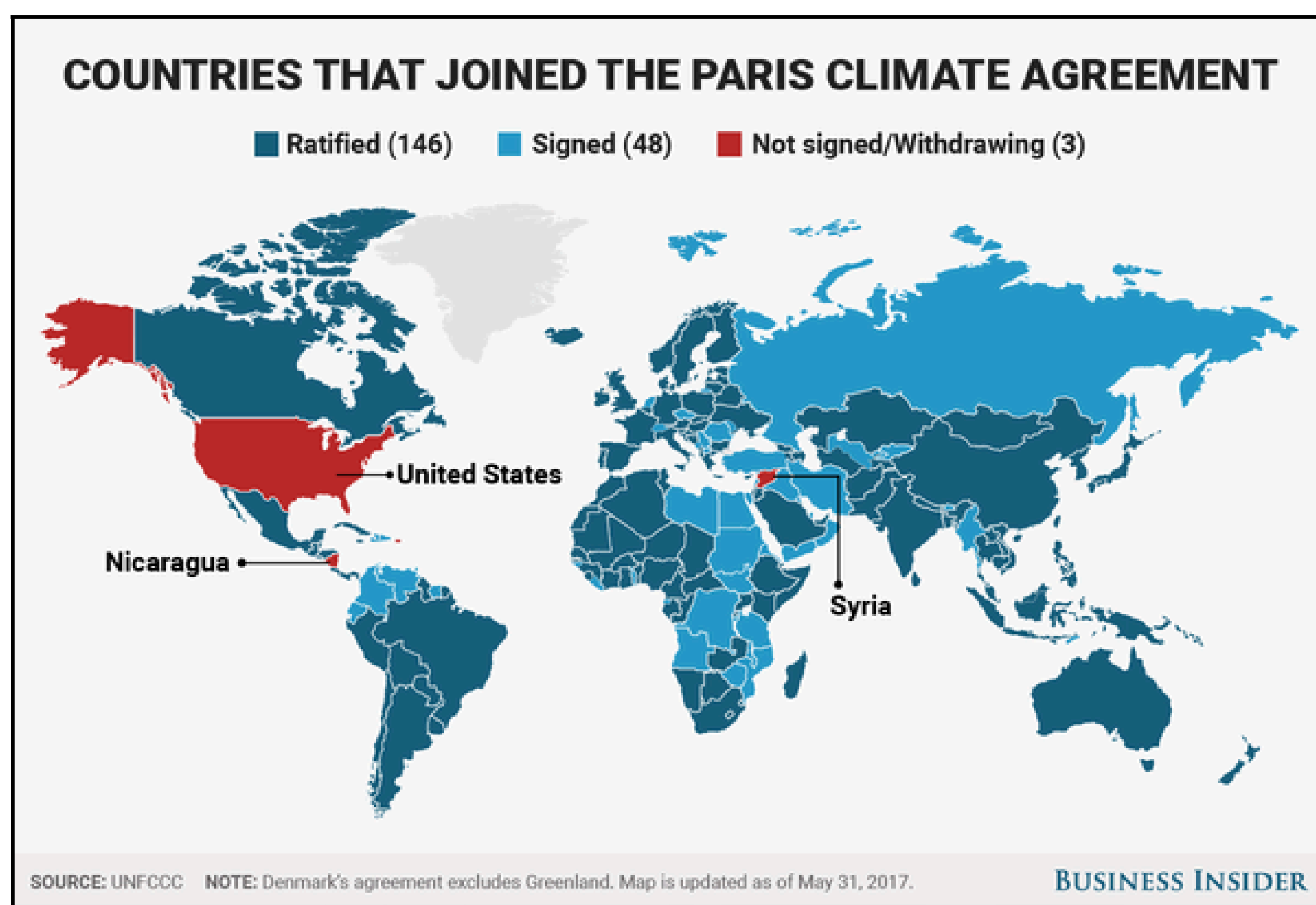
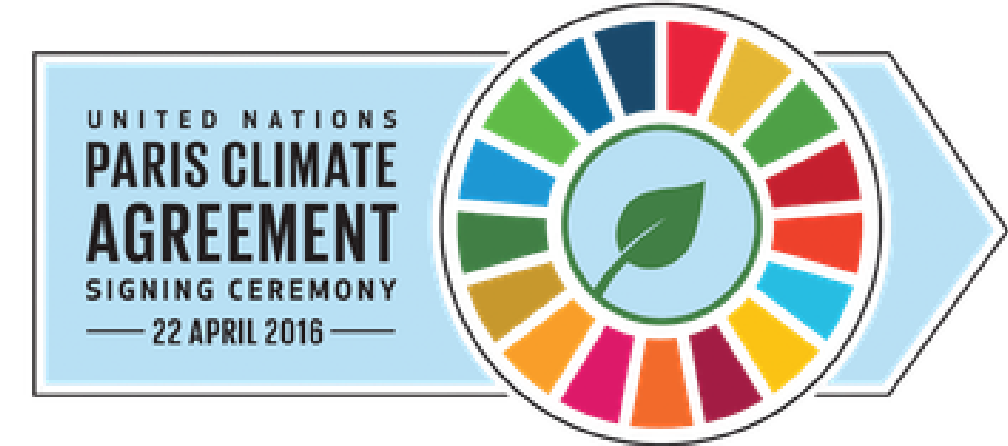
Due to its valuable, rich natural resources and some new emerging opportunities in the Arctic area, Greenland has a high economic value. It is believed to contain high value elements which are critical for modern technologies, petrol, and natural gas. As ice melts, it gets easier to access those resources and causes international interest for this region. Also Greenland is near to some sea routes which can decrease costs of shipping between Europe and Asia. Northern Sea Route decreases distance of route %40 in Atlantic Ocean. This makes Greenland more valuable global trade.

f. Current Situation

The Arctic region is currently experiencing rapid change due to climate change and increasing geopolitical interest. Melting ice is opening new shipping routes and making natural resources more accessible, which attracts global attention. As a result, countries such as the United States and Russia are increasing their military and strategic presence in the region. At the same time, non-Arctic states like China are expanding their economic and scientific involvement.

5. Case Studies in International Law

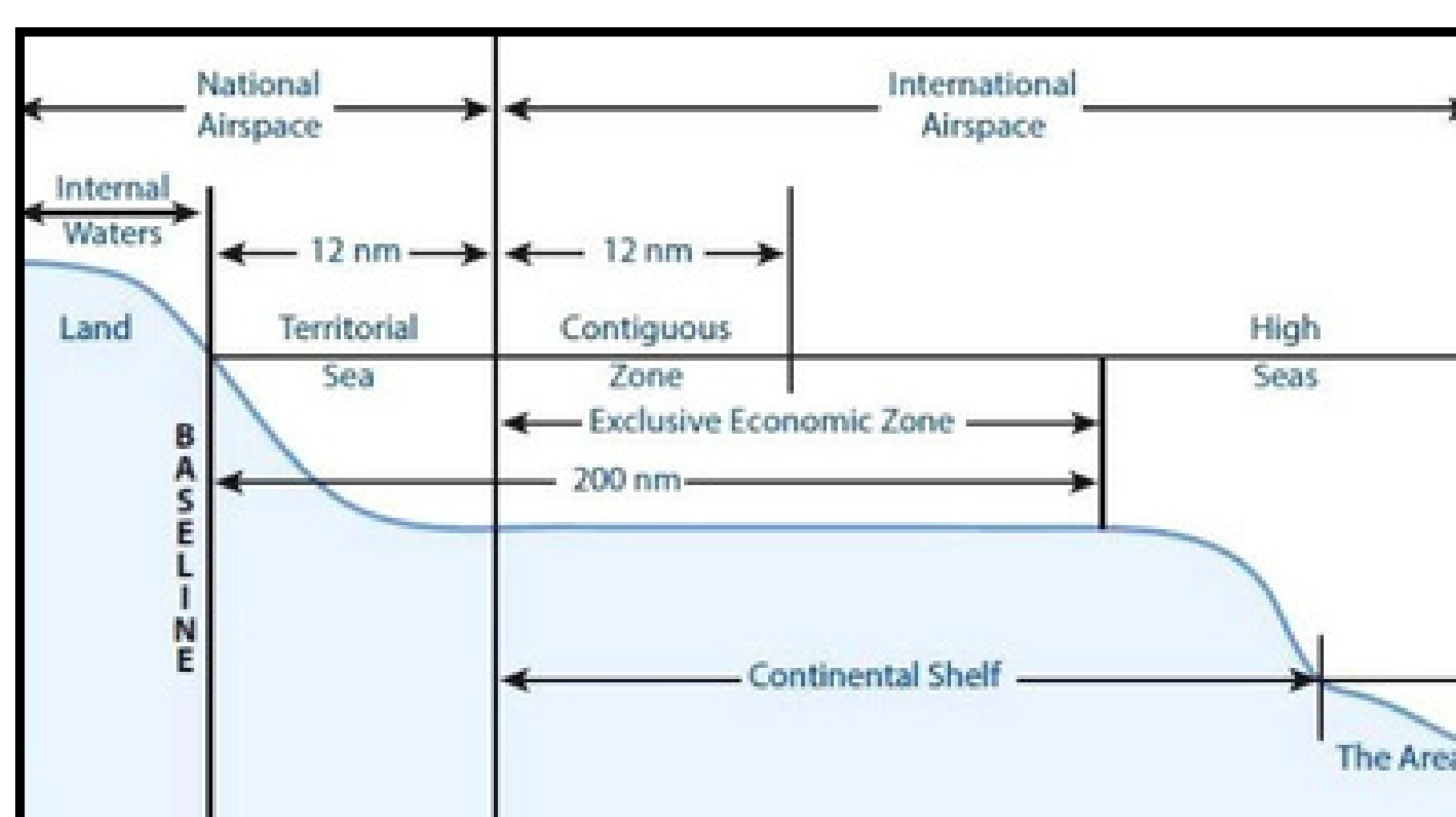
a. Paris Environment Agreement: The Paris Agreement is an international treaty adopted in 2015 under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). It aims to address global climate change by limiting the increase in the Earth's average temperature. The main goal of this agreement is keeping the global temperature increase below 2°C and limiting it to 1.5°C if possible. Also developed countries are expected to give financial support, technology and information to help undeveloped countries adapt to climate change.



b. UNCLOS: UNCLOS is an international agreement adopted in 1982 by the United Nations. It sets the rules for how countries use the oceans and seas.

Its main goals are to:

- Decide who controls different parts of the sea
- Protect the marine environment
- Ensuring countries are fair at using resources

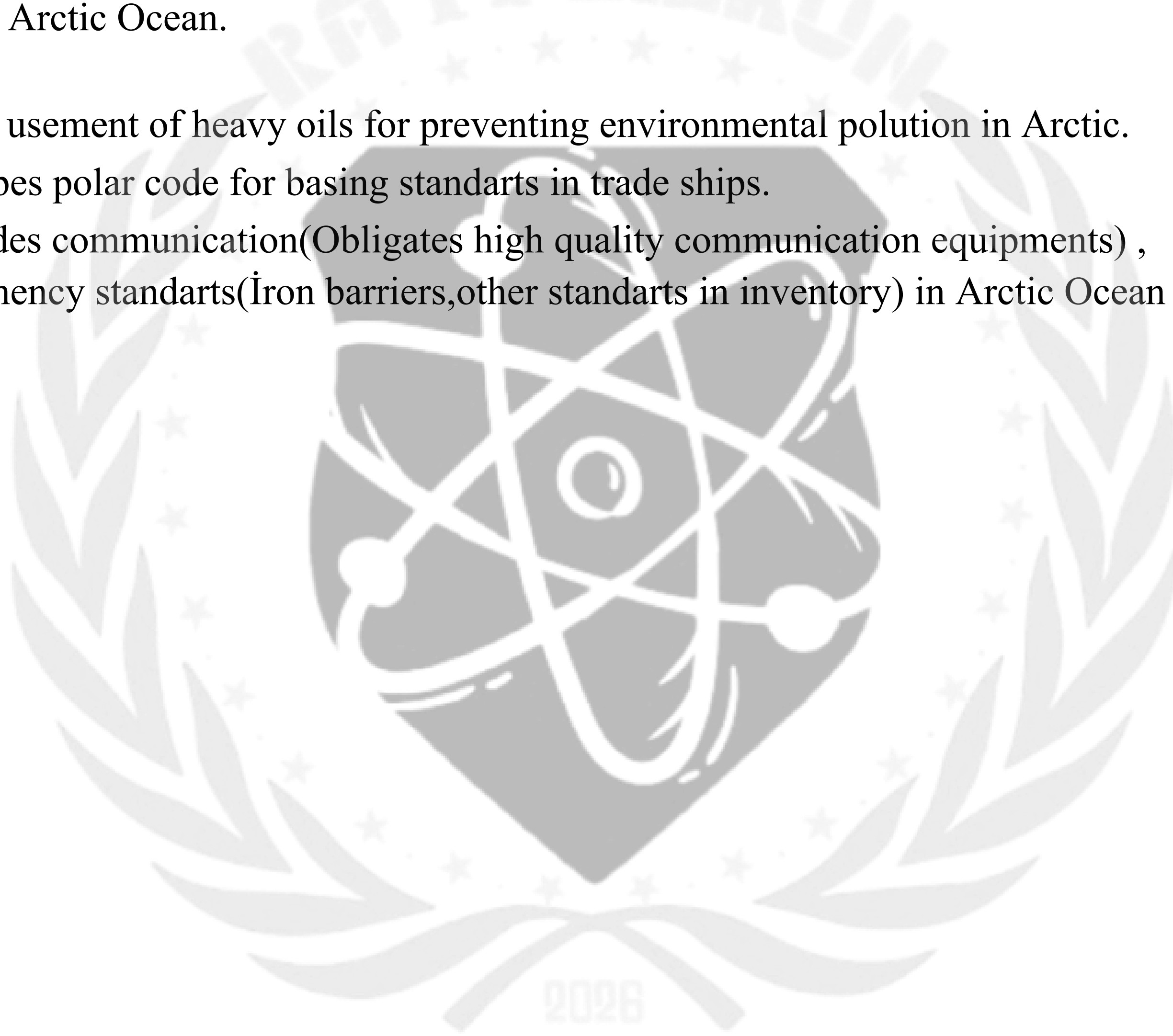


c. Arctic Council: Arctic Council is a treaty organization for providing military disarmament and military stability in Arctic Ocean that founded by Ottawa Declaration with cooperation of 8 countries. Arctic Council advances on agendas about legal, environmental and scientific issues. Here are the some examples Arctic Council does:

- Provides search and rescue operations and clearly decides to sharement and payment of operation and organizes it.
- Prevents and predicts about potencial oil tanker accidents and takes action
- Prepares guides and... about safement and sustainability of trade routes of Northern Sea Route and NorthWest Passage.

d. International Maritime Organization: IMO is a international organization for advancing and tracking rules for providing security and sustainability in Arctic Ocean. Arctic Ocean has differences with its climate and geography. IMO organizes and updates rules for trade and researches for Arctic Ocean.

- Forbids usement of heavy oils for preventing environmental polution in Arctic.
- Developes polar code for basing standarts in trade ships.
- It includes communication(Obligates high quality communication equipments) , equipmency standarts(Iron barriers, other standarts in inventory) in Arctic Ocean



6. Critical Countries and Their Views

1. USA:

The United States sees the Arctic as an important area because of its location and natural resources. It stands up for freedom of navigation. Russia's growing military presence makes the USA concerned, and it causes the growth of its own military presence.

- Sees Arctic as an important area
- Supports freedom of navigation
- Concerned about Russia's military presence
- Increases its military strength

2. Russia

The Arctic is vital for Russia due to security and economic concerns. It holds the control of the Northern Sea Route out of its hands. Its military presence significantly expanded in the region. Especially after Russo-Ukrainian War(2022), Russia blockades Arctic Council for causing political issues.

- The most powerful Arctic country
- Sees the area critical for security and economy
- Controls the Northern Sea Route
- Increases its military presence
- Focused on oil and natural gas sources and mining zones
- Improves icebreakers and military bases from Soviet Era for increase affect in Arctic

3. China

China assumes that it is a near Arctic state. It argues for international cooperation, and stands against the idea that the Arctic should only be controlled by Arctic states. China's main interests are trade routes, energy resources and scientific research.

- Stands up for International cooperation
- Supports the idea of "The Arctic should not be only controlled by Arctic states".
- Interested in energy, research and trade routes

4. Denmark

Denmark supports peaceful cooperation, environmental protection and sustainable development. Their policy related to the Arctic is mostly shaped by Greenland. In addition, it benefits from Greenland's natural resources, which is an economic advantage for Denmark.

- Supports peace and environment protection
- Mostly aligned with NATO
- Gains economic advantage from natural resource

5. Canada

The Arctic is an important part of its national sovereignty for Canada. It claims control over sea routes, for example the Northwest passage. Canada also stands up for environmental protection and indigenous rights. In addition, military presence is increased in a neglectable amount.

- Considers arctic as a part of its national sovereignty
- Assumes Northwest Passage as internal waters
- Emphasizes the importance of environmental protection
- Increases military presence

6. Norway

As a member of NATO, Norway is involved in the Arctic. It backs international law, especially UNCLOS, and encourages stability and cooperation. While keeping strong environmental standards, Norway also produces oil and gas.

- Supports UNCLOS
- Plays active role at oil and gas production
- Stands up for cooperation
- Aims to maintain stability
- NATO member

7. Historical Context of Political Tension in Arctic Ocean and North Pole

From Isolation to Strategic Interest

For a time people thought of the Arctic as a place that was far away and hard to get to. It was really cold, had a lot of ice and not many people lived there so it wasn't a part of international politics.. Things started to change after World War II. As the United States and the Soviet Union began to have problems, military leaders in both countries realized that the Arctic was actually a way between them.

Because of this the High North started to become more important. What was once seen as a barrier was now thought of as a path for military planes and later missile systems.

Early Cold War Militarization

The years of the Cold War marked the start of the Arctic becoming a military area. Both the United States and the Soviet Union began testing whether they could operate militarily in harsh conditions.

The United States did cold-weather missions, like Operation Frostbite and Operation Nanook to test their equipment, planes, communication systems and how well their personnel could handle it. These operations showed that they could deploy in the Arctic. It was expensive and required a lot of technology.



The Soviet Union used its coastline to its advantage. Through the Sever expeditions Soviet planes worked near the North Pole showing that the USSR could operate in the Arctic.

By the 1940s it was clear that the Arctic would no longer be left out of politics.

The DEW Line and Arctic Defense Infrastructure

During the 1950s the Arctic strategy went from testing to becoming a part of military planning. Fears of an air attack led the United States and Canada to build the Distant Early Warning Line (DEW Line), a radar network from Alaska to Greenland.



Its main job was to detect Soviet bombers before they reached North America.. The DEW Line also created a semi-permanent Western military presence along the Arctic coastline. The project required a lot of planning. Showed how important the region had become in Cold War security plans.

At the time Canada increased its activity in the Arctic with voyages like HMCS Labrador's crossing of the Northwest Passage in 1954 strengthening Canada's claims to the area.

The Soviet response focused on mobility rather than fixed radar systems. Drifting ice stations and the launch of the nuclear-powered icebreaker Lenin showed Moscow's effort to maintain access to the Arctic.

Missile Technology and the Nuclear Arctic

A major shift happened after 1957 when the Soviet Union launched Sputnik. This showed that the Soviet Union had rocket technology meaning that future nuclear missiles could cross the Arctic quickly. As a result the Arctic became a front in nuclear deterrence.

The United States reacted by expanding missile detection systems while submarine competition also increased. In 1958 USS Nautilus completed the underwater transit beneath the North Pole showing that Arctic ice was no longer a secure barrier.



The Soviet Union began using Arctic waters as a zone for its nuclear submarine fleet, particularly around the Kola Peninsula. By the 1970s the Arctic had become one of the heavily militarized yet least visible areas of the Cold War.

A Brief Period of Cooperation

Despite military competition the Arctic also saw limited diplomatic cooperation. The 1973 Polar Bear Conservation Agreement was one of the examples of Arctic states working together on environmental concerns.

This cooperative trend became more visible in the 1980s. In 1987 Mikhail Gorbachev called for reducing tension in the Arctic and increasing peaceful scientific cooperation. His proposal helped change the narrative of the region.

The establishment of the Arctic Council in 1996 institutionalized dialogue on issues like protection, indigenous communities and sustainable development. For a period the Arctic was often described as a cooperative geopolitical space.

Renewed Competition in the Century

This cooperative atmosphere began to weaken after 2007. Russia's placement of a titanium flag on the seabed below the North Pole signaled a return of territorial claims. At the time melting ice due to climate change made Arctic shipping routes and natural resources more accessible.

This changed the value of the region significantly. The Arctic was no longer important for military positioning but also for:

new commercial shipping lanes,

oil and gas reserves,

rare earth minerals,

and strategic control of maritime access.

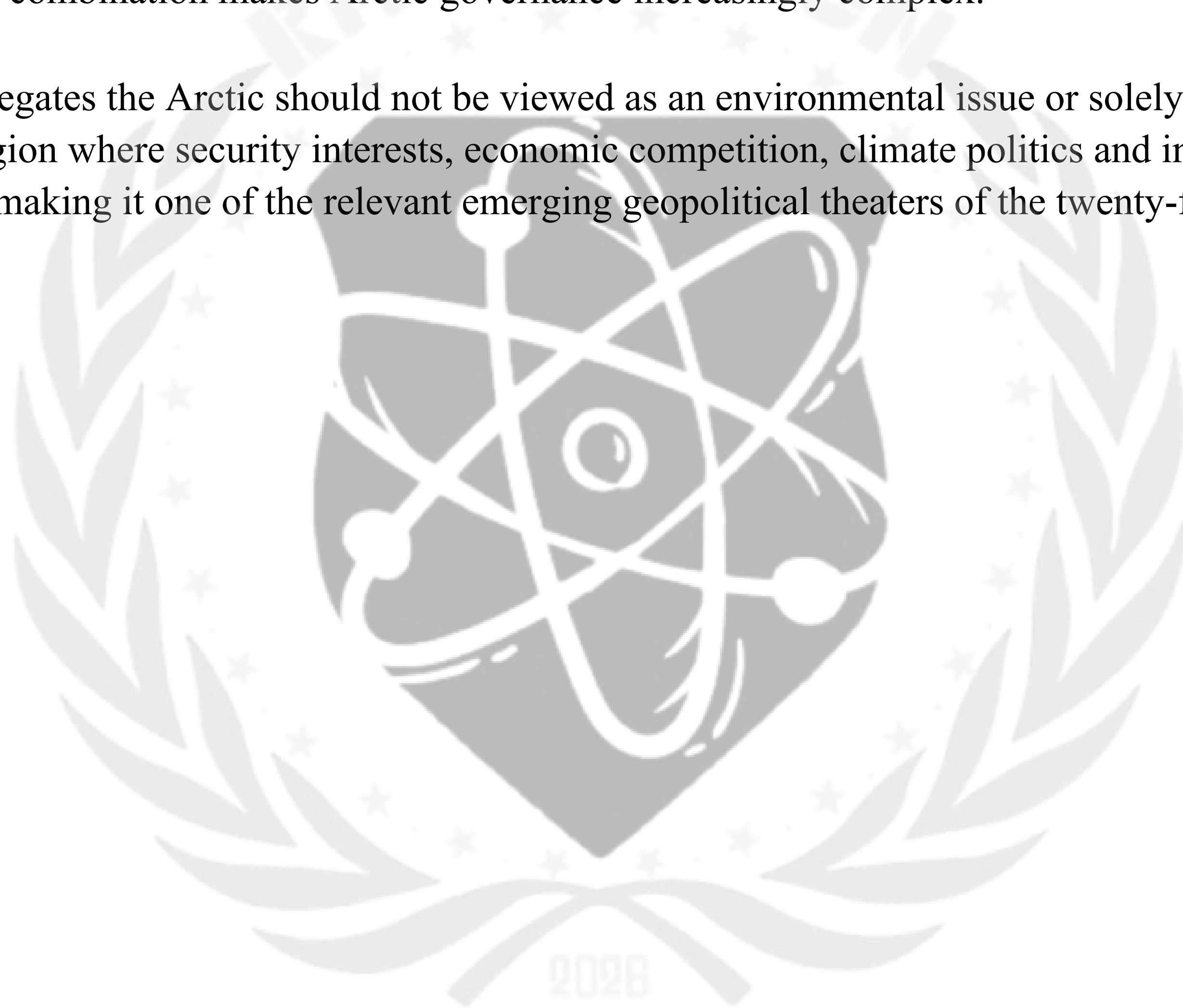
The region also began attracting -Arctic powers. China declared itself a Near-Arctic State and increased investment in Arctic research and infrastructure demonstrating that Arctic competition had become global rather than purely regional.

Since 2022 tensions between Russia and Western Arctic states have further weakened the mechanisms built in the previous decades.

Why This Matters for Today

The Arctic's importance today comes from the fact that several issues overlap in the region at once. It remains a security zone, an environmental hotspot, a resource frontier and a growing maritime corridor. This combination makes Arctic governance increasingly complex.

For MUN delegates the Arctic should not be viewed as an environmental issue or solely, as a military one. It is a region where security interests, economic competition, climate politics and international law intersect making it one of the relevant emerging geopolitical theaters of the twenty-first century.



8. Grey-Zone Operations and Hybrid Threats in the Arctic

a. Conceptual Framework: Why Does This Matter?

Security discussions in the Arctic are generally about ice breaker ships, military bases and fighter jets. Whereas the biggest reason for instability is below-threshold activities. These activities are operations which are not considered as a war by international laws. However, operations erode sovereign rights.

b. Five Identified Grey-Zone Threats in the Arctic

1. Submarine Critical Infrastructure Sabotage

A considerable amount of the world's internet traffic is provided by fiber optic cables that go through Arctic waters. If these cables get damaged or impacted, global finance and communication would be paralyzed. In addition, identification of perpetrators is extremely difficult

2. Hybrid Operations Utilizing "Civilian" Vessels

Especially sanctioned states mostly use shadow fleets which consist of old and uninsured tankers. These ships close their AIS signals while traveling through the Arctic waters, an action that provides compensation for maritime traffic.

3. Intelligence Gathering Under the Guise of Scientific Research

Some states use the Arctic's scientific research expeditions for mapping the sea floor, which is called dual-use research. Datas are critical for submarine navigation and warfare.

4. GPS Signal Jamming and Spoofing

Intentional disruption of GPS signals during military exercises in the Arctic region, threatens civilian aviation and maritime directly in Norway and Finland.

5. Manipulation of Indigenous Populations via Social Media and Disinformation

Disinformation campaigns sponsored by states cause political preferences of indigenous people open to external intervention, which is a thread that targets social fabric of the Arctic.

c. Gaps in the Existing Legal Framework

UNCLOS (1982)	Provides for the protection of submarine cables	No definition of "shadow fleet." Ambiguous sanctions mechanism for non-state actors causing intentional damage to cables.
Paris Climate Agreement	Limits greenhouse gas emissions	Lacks provisions for emergency response and liability regarding sudden environmental disasters (e.g., oil spills) caused by hybrid operations.



9. Future Scenarios for the Arctic Region

The Arctic is changing rapidly. Climate change is getting worse, the political tension is increasing. The future is hard to predict for the countries playing a role in the Arctic region. In this case, considering every different scenario is a must. The most commonly discussed future scenarios are as follows:

1. High Militarization Scenario

- Tension between USA and Russia rises
- Military presence expands
- Risk of conflict borns
- Arctic becomes a zone of strategic rivalry

2. International Cooperation Scenario

- Countries prioritize diplomacy and cooperation
- Environmental protection efforts increases
- Reduced tensions and increased stability

3. Economic Competition Scenario

- Interest in oil, gas and natural resources rapidly grows
- Expansion of trade routes in the region
- Involvement of countries are not near to arctic like China
- Economic competition causes political tension

Most Likely Scenario

Even though every scenario is still possible, the most likely one is the combination of economic competition and increasing militarization. Formation of new trade routes caused by the melt of ice will attract major powers such as the USA and China. These changes may cause economic rivalry. Still direct conflict is expected to be prevented by international frameworks.

10. Negotiation Strategy Map

a. Security-Oriented Powers (Russia, United States)

Core Interests

- Keeping military presence in the Arctic
- Providing national security
- Taking the control of key maritime routes

Red Lines

- Limitation of military presence in the Arctic
- Loss of the strategic and military influence in the area
- Regulations that restricts the air mobility
- Proposals for disarmament of the Arctic

Leverage Tools

- Advanced military bases and navy
- Strategic deterrence policies
- Military presence in the region

Negotiation Behaviour

- USA emphasizes rules based order
- Russia promotes sovereignty and defense

b. Sovereignty-Focused Arctic States (Canada, Denmark)

Core Interests

- Control over the Arctic maritime routes
- Recognition of the sovereignty rights of land and sea areas in international level

Red Lines

- Questioning their sovereignty claims
- Internationalization of inland seas

Leverage Tools

- Legal frameworks such as UNCLOS
- Scientific datas (proof of continental shelf)

Negotiation Behaviour

- Relies on legal arguments

- Prefers diplomacy and enterprise solutions
- Avoids from tension yet doesn't compromise sovereignty

c. Economic / Access-oriented Actors (China)

Core Interests

- Access to Arctic trade routes
- Attendance to economic opportunities and resources

Red Lines

- Being excluded from the Arctic management
- Limitation of economic access

Leverage Tools

- Enterprises and infrastructure projects
- Scientific researches

Negotiation Behaviour

- Emphasizes cooperation and multilateralism
- Uses “common future ” expression
- Aims to create long term presence

d. Stabilizer / Balance States (Norway)

Core Interests

- regional stability
- Balance between NATO and Russia

Red Lines

- Growth of military tension
- Collapse of cooperation mechanisms

Leverage Tools

- Diplomatic reliability
- Active role in Arctic Council

Negotiation Behaviour

- Plays a mediating role
- Supports dialogue and transparency
- Avoids extreme positions

11. Questions To Be Answered

- In order to contain the military buildup between the United States and the Russian Federation in the Arctic region, which of the Cold War-era nuclear deterrence models can be adapted to today's concept of "Arctic Exceptionalism"?
- In order to increase the transparency of military activity in the region and prevent a possible hot conflict, can a "Confidence Building Measures (CBM) Protocol" be established within DISEC, in which the parties share their military data?
- Is granting the Arctic an international status (Common Heritage of Mankind) or recognizing the sovereignty claims of riparian states under UNCLOS more sustainable for regional stability?
- Should an "Additional Protocol on Neutrality and Security" specific to the Arctic region be prepared in order to eliminate the existing legal gaps (greyzones) of UNCLOS and sabotage risks against submarine infrastructures?
- How should an international distribution policy be structured regarding the sharing and supply of rare earth element reserves in the Arctic region to prevent unfair competition from turning into a "resource war"?
- How can the economic independence of regions with strategic rare earth elements, like Greenland, be protected from the interference of global powers like the USA, Russia, and China?
- How can the "demilitarized and free zone" status of the 1920 Svalbard Treaty be used as a model for other disputed areas in the Arctic, such as the Lomonosov Ridge?
- If the Svalbard model is applied to the whole Arctic, how can we maintain the balance between NATO's security structure and Russia's defense strategies?
- Is it possible to establish an international "Underwater Infrastructure Inspection Mechanism" to prevent hybrid threats against fiber optic cables and communication lines in the Arctic?
- What kind of legal and financial sanctions should be developed under UNCLOS against "Shadow Fleets" that turn off their AIS signals to avoid international rules?

- How should an "Arctic Environmental Monitoring and Emergency Response Network" be funded to prevent economic activities from damaging the local ecosystem, in line with the Paris Agreement?
- How can the security concerns and decision-making rights of the Arctic indigenous peoples (local communities) be included in the planning of military and economic projects?



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